



Traveller's tree



For a long time, the traveller's tree was a puzzle. Why does it hide its flowers inside tough cases and have bright-blue seeds? Then, scientists saw monkey-like lemurs breaking into the flowers to eat the sweet nectar. As they do this, pollen sticks to the lemur's fur and when they move between trees, they spread the pollen. They also eat the tree's seeds, and spread them in their poo. The seeds are blue to help the lemurs spot them. The trees and lemurs help each other.

The leaves of the traveller's tree overlap to form a huge fan. As the tree grows, its bottom leaves fall off, so the huge fan travels upwards.

There is a myth that the traveller's tree's leaves always point in the same direction, so travellers can use them to find their way.

